

Studies in Literature, Grade 12

College Preparation

ETS4C

This course is for students with a special interest in literature. The course may focus on themes, genres, time periods, or countries. Students will study a variety of forms and stylistic elements of literary texts and respond personally, critically, and creatively to them. They will also investigate critical interpretations and complete an independent study project.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 11, College Preparation

Strands

The expectations in this course are organized into a single strand.

STUDIES IN LITERATURE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- 1. Understanding Texts:** read and demonstrate understanding of a variety of literary texts from different countries, cultures, and historical periods;
- 2. Analysing Texts:** respond to and analyse literary texts to develop and extend their understanding of how content, form, and style in combination communicate meaning and enhance a text's effectiveness;
- 3. Critical Literacy:** demonstrate an understanding that the perspective of the author, the reader, and the text all influence the reading experience;
- 4. Literary Criticism:** use literary criticism to enhance their understanding of literature;
- 5. The Role of Literature in Society:** assess the importance of literature as a social and cultural force.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

1. Understanding Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- 1.1** read a variety of types of literary texts, with an emphasis on works with engaging, relevant themes, by contemporary authors from a variety of cultures (e.g., *create an annotated bibliography of sports titles they have read, with brief notes about their reactions to each title; design a self-selected reading list, in consultation with the teacher, to explore a topic of interest; create a reader's scrapbook, recording details of the text types and topics covered in their reading during the year*)

Teacher prompts: "What types of texts are you most interested in reading?" "Which kinds of texts do you find most challenging or least interesting?" "What factors do you consider when you select reading material?"

Reading With a Purpose

- 1.2** identify the purpose (or purposes) for reading particular literary texts (e.g., *a text that explores a particular theme, for personal interest; a web-site, to locate author information; the opening passages from different texts, to preview content while considering a reading choice*)

Teacher prompts: "What do you hope to find out by reading that text? How will you use the information?" "What do you read just for

fun?" "Is your approach to reading different when you decide on a purpose for reading before you begin a text?" "When are you most likely to have a very clear purpose for reading?"

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- 1.3** identify a variety of reading comprehension strategies and use them before, during, and after reading to enhance their understanding of texts (e.g., *annotate a short excerpt from a graphic novel to explain inferences, make connections, record questions and reactions, paraphrase themes, and interpret graphics; create a mind map to summarize character information, quotations, and inferences; deconstruct a passage from a text, recording the results of their analysis in a graphic organizer*)

Teacher prompts: "How does displaying your ideas in the graphic organizer help you as a reader?" "What questions were you able to answer about the story as a result of the Think/Pair/Share activity?"

2. Analysing Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Responding to Texts

- 2.1** respond to texts in a variety of ways before, during, and after reading to extend their understanding of the ideas, themes, and issues

explored in the texts (e.g., write an anecdote to explain a feeling of personal connection to a character or event in a text; create a website for a character from a play; create a cartoon strip to depict an important scene from a text; develop questions to ask in a mock TV interview with a fictional character; develop a dialogue between two fictional characters who meet twenty years into the future; retell an incident from a text in the style of a newspaper report and/or an electronic text message; write a letter to a classmate reflecting on questions they thought of while reading a text; keep a graphic record, such as a scrapbook, of personal reactions to ideas from texts)

Teacher prompts: “Is the situation the character faces similar to anything you have experienced? In what way?” “After your book club meeting, what new questions did you have about the novel?”

Exploring Background Information

2.2 use information from secondary sources to understand how historical, political, and cultural contexts influence the presentation of ideas, issues, and themes in texts (e.g., create a timeline that includes events in a text and real-world events at the time and place of writing, and relate the subject matter of the text to its real-world context; use evidence from advertisements, songs, or movies from the time when a text was written to make inferences about the cultural and social values of the time)

Teacher prompts: “Does knowing the historical background change your understanding of some of the conflicts in the text?” “What major themes emerged when you read various texts on the same topic?”

Analysing Texts

2.3 analyse texts in terms of the information, ideas, issues, and themes they explore, providing evidence from the texts to support their analysis (e.g., participate in a debate about whether a character in a play acted correctly to resolve a moral dilemma; identify appropriate actors for the different characters in a film adaptation of a story and justify their choices using evidence from the text; adopt the persona of a character from a short story to write a journal entry dated five years after the story ends; determine whether a piece of humorous writing has a serious purpose, describing its themes and the issues it addresses; select a short piece of prose or poetry and create a series of tableaux to illustrate its theme)

Teacher prompts: “What details in the text would you use to explain your character analysis to your classmates?” “Is there more than one possible interpretation of this character’s actions? What clues can you find in the text that support the different interpretations?”

Text Forms

2.4 explain how the characteristics of different text forms help communicate meaning in a variety of literary texts (e.g., explain how the conventions of the science fiction and the romance genres influence the endings of a short story of each type; explain how the organizational pattern of a poem helps communicate the theme)

Teacher prompt: “What similarities and differences are there in the way short stories and narrative poems are written? How can we use this information about form to help us understand works of both types?”

Elements of Style

2.5 identify various elements of style used in texts and explain how they help communicate meaning and enhance the effectiveness of the text (e.g., compare the openings of two novels in terms of tone, mood, atmosphere, and style and make predictions about genre, theme, type of action, and characterization based on this preview; identify clues in the dialogue in a text that provide information about the social class and personality traits of the characters; compare a serious report of an incident with a parody or comic depiction of the event and describe how the different voices used in the two versions affect their perception of the event; identify and explain the effect of rhetorical devices used in song lyrics; identify the rhetorical devices and strategies used in a famous persuasive speech)

Teacher prompts: “When do you think it would be effective and appropriate to use slang in a literary text?” “What does the dialogue reveal about this character?” “What rhetorical devices are used most effectively by your favourite singer/songwriter? How are they similar to those used by another writer you are studying in the course?”

3. Critical Literacy

By the end of this course, students will:

The Author’s Perspective

3.1 demonstrate an understanding of how an author’s writing has been influenced by factors such as gender, time period, cultural

background, and social and political conditions and events (e.g., *compare stories about the “coming of age” experience by authors from different cultures, using a Venn diagram to help identify the aspects of the authors’ accounts that are attributable to the influence of cultural background; describe various aspects of the cultural context revealed in an Aboriginal writer’s autobiography; use biographical information from print and electronic sources to connect recurrent themes in an author’s work to the author’s life experiences*)

Teacher prompt: “What ideas expressed by the author are a reflection of attitudes that were popular at the time the book was written? Does this knowledge alter your opinions about the text?”

Audience Perspectives

3.2 analyse texts in terms of how social, cultural, and political contexts and different readers’ personal perspectives may influence readers’ interpretations of the text (e.g., *in a journal entry, explain how aspects of their own personal experience, background knowledge, or cultural heritage have influenced their reading of a text; use a graphic organizer to categorize texts in terms of the audience(s) they are primarily intended for, or are most likely to appeal to*)

Teacher prompts: “What background knowledge and personal experience did you bring to the reading experience?” “Why do you think certain texts appeal more to one type of reader than another?”

Perspectives in the Text

3.3 analyse texts to identify particular perspectives presented in them and the stylistic and/or structural means used to communicate those perspectives (e.g., *identify competing perspectives presented in a text and use clues from the text to determine which of them, if any, the author appears to favour; compare two book reviews to show how reviewers bring different and unique perspectives to their analysis; identify individuals or groups who are referred to in a text but whose own voices are not heard, and suggest reasons for the omission, including reasons related to the historical or socio-political context at the time the text was written*)

Teacher prompts: “Which aspects of the minor characters’ lives are highlighted in the text and which are ignored?” “Is one perspective dominant in this text, or are several different perspectives presented in comparable detail and depth?”

4. Literary Criticism

By the end of this course, students will:

Understanding Literary Concepts and Terms

4.1 demonstrate an understanding of key concepts and specialized terms that are used in literary criticism (e.g., *create a multimedia presentation to highlight and explain the key literary terms and theories associated with some of the texts or genres represented in the course; maintain a personal dictionary of the literary terms and specialized language used in the course; design and construct a word wall of key literary concepts and specialized terms related to a particular text*)

Teacher prompt: “Do you think knowing the literary terms for various stylistic elements helps you recognize the elements more easily in texts?”

Applying Concepts

4.2 use key concepts or approaches of literary criticism to help them analyse and interpret literary texts (e.g., *present an interpretation of a play or novel in the form of a psychiatrist’s “case study” of the characters’ motivations and behaviour; use a specific critical approach to prepare an interpretation of a text for a seminar presentation*)

Teacher prompt: “What literary theory did you apply to help you deconstruct the text? Did applying the theory provide you with new insights into the text?”

Researching and Evaluating Critical Interpretations

4.3 assess critical interpretations found in print and electronic sources and use those that seem most appropriate, helpful, or convincing to extend their understanding of texts studied in the course (e.g., *read online analyses or reviews of texts, list those they found most interesting, and explain why; participate in a literature circle in the role of summarizer, questioner, commentator, or wordsmith to share responses to and evaluate a critical article on a text*)

Teacher prompts: “Is this critic’s interpretation of the text convincing? Is there specific evidence in the text to support a different interpretation?” “How did your reading of the review influence your appreciation of the story? Why is it important to think about who wrote the review?”

Assessing Peer Critical Responses

4.4 compare peers’ critical responses with their own to clarify and extend their understanding of literary texts (e.g., *write a commentary on a*

peer's interpretation of a text, noting both useful insights and possible misinterpretations and supporting their own opinions with evidence from the text; reflect and comment on the critical response of a peer in a Say Something activity)

Teacher prompt: "To what extent do you agree with your classmate's analysis of the text? What specific evidence from the text and your own reading experience would you use to support an alternative interpretation?"

5. The Role of Literature in Society

By the end of this course, students will:

Fostering Social, Cultural, and Political Awareness

5.1 explain how literary texts raise awareness about a range of topics, issues, ideas, cultures, events, and people (e.g., compare literary essays on a particular issue or topic written from different perspectives, describe the effect of the essays on their own thinking, and determine which view, if any, they are most likely to agree with; explain how a story by an Aboriginal writer affected their understanding of some of the current social and/or political concerns of Aboriginal peoples; read a text that discusses an international conflict and reflect, in a journal entry, on insights they have gained from the text into the causes of the conflict and/or the psychology of the opposing parties)

Teacher prompt: "How do these authors' ideas about social justice compare with your own?"

Engaging the Intellect and the Imagination

5.2 identify ways in which literary texts can promote readers' intellectual and imaginative growth (e.g., describe how a work of science fiction or a graphic novel has stimulated their imagination or intellectual curiosity; identify three quotations or passages from a novel that challenged them intellectually, and explain why the passages were challenging; identify three poetic images that inspired them and analyse their effect)

Teacher prompt: "Which of these texts made you want to learn more about the topic? Which made you question your assumptions? Which made you want to write a story of your own?"

Promoting Personal and Social Change

5.3 identify ways in which literary texts might promote social and personal change (e.g., explain why a contemporary text is considered controversial; identify a controversial text from

the past and explain why it is or is not still controversial today; design an advertising campaign to "sell" a point of view about an issue raised in a text they have read; write a "theme song" for a marginalized character depicted in a text they have read)

Teacher prompts: "What have you read that has changed your opinions or behaviour?" "Do you think there is truth in the saying 'The pen is mightier than the sword'? Why, or why not?"

Exploring Human Nature

5.4 explain how the study of literature has contributed to their understanding of human nature (e.g., identify passages from literary texts that illustrate the capacity for forgiveness in human beings; identify a text that depicts human behaviour in difficult circumstances and comment on what they have learned from it, using words, visuals, or some other form of expression; use a Venn diagram to compare the views of human nature presented in texts by two different authors)

Teacher prompts: "Can reading literary works help you to develop empathy?" "What does this character's desire for revenge reveal about our human need to be respected and valued?" "What part of the text suggests to you that the author's view of humanity is generally positive?"

Developing Personal Awareness

5.5 explain how their study of literature has enhanced their understanding of themselves as readers and as individuals (e.g., identify and monitor the development of their reading skills in a reflective journal, and recognize their progress; identify fix-up strategies that they find most useful during reading; identify ways in which their own social and cultural contexts may enhance or limit their understanding of texts; in a literature circle, explain how a particular reading strategy helped them gain insight into a passage from a text; select a text that taught them a powerful life lesson and explain to a small group why it has particular meaning for them)

Teacher prompts: "Has your participation in the book club meetings changed how you think about ideas and issues presented in texts?" "What, if any, personal benefit do you think you derive from reading literary texts?"